

The Logic of the Fundamental Ideas

in Brief Compass.

By

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Foreword

In this little book the author has endeavoured to give a short and clear presentation of his theistic logic. He has therein found occasion to bring out the nodal points on which the scientific dispute between pantheism and theism must essentially turn.

R. Nielsen.

Introduction

At the present stage of philosophy's development it becomes a scientific necessity to treat logic from three essentially different points of view.

In order to develop the laws of thinking, one must keep to thinking itself. But thinking is a human activity of spirit; we must learn what thinking is from our own thinking. It lies near, then, to regard the human being as the thinking subject, to reflect upon the mutual relations of the acts of thought, and to mark the forms necessary for the understanding, the intellectual traces which advancing thought deposits. This point of view is characteristic of *formal logic*.

It is, however, so far from being the case that the finite understanding should command the demands of thought, that these must on the contrary be said to command the thinker; there shall be thinking, but when the thinking is consistent it is for the rest indifferent who it is that thinks — whether it be a human being or a god or perhaps pure being. The emphasis falls on the thinking. For thinking's own sake, on the other hand, it is of importance to fix the eye on that which is thought, on the universally necessary content; for the content of thought and the form of thought are determined by one another. This point of view is characteristic of the *speculative* or, to use a perhaps still more telling expression, *the immanent logic*.

These two principal forms of logic, of which the first has an Aristotle, the second a Hegel, as supreme representative, may with reason be said to enjoy a well-deserved recognition in science.

That they cannot well be reconciled with one another, but stand in a most serious dispute concerning the very first principles of thinking, notably the principle of contradiction, is certainly less commendable; but they will both maintain their place:

the one will not be able to displace the other.

In order that each of the contending parties may come fully into its right, it is in our judgment necessary that yet a third principal form be introduced. But before we attempt to prove the correctness of this assertion, we consider it expedient to bring the architectonic opposition between the two doctrinal edifices nearer to intuition by prefacing an outline corresponding to each of them.

Formal Logic.

Formal logic, or the doctrine of the abstractly necessary thought-forms, divides into the doctrine of *Concept*, *Judgment* and *Inference*.

Concept.

Thinking, which is already present in sensation, raises itself forth as it dissolves the immediate sense-images, forms by comparison and abstraction a *general image*, holds it fast in the *word*, makes clear to itself the essential marks that necessarily belong together, and transforms it into a *concept* (concept-analysis, definition).

The sum of the determinations belonging to a concept constitutes the concept's *content*; the number of the objects to which it finds application designates its *extension*. (Inverse relation between content and extension; superordinate and subordinate concepts; genus- and species-concepts.)

Judgment.

The concept finds its pure logical expression only in language: words are joined into sentences, and in sentences judgments are uttered. The sentence whose form expresses a concept is a *logical judgment*. In order to express the concept in this form, the judgment must formally indicate: the *Subject*, the representation that is to be determined; the *Predicate*, the determining representation; and the *Copula*, the determining word of connection.

From the subject's connection with the predicate, determined by the copula, it follows that the judgment can be separated into a plurality of logically different judgments, and judgments are divided: according to *quality* into affirmative, negative and infinite; according to *quantity* into singular, particular and general; according to *relation* into categorical, hypothetical and disjunctive; according to *modality* into assertoric, problematic and apodictic.

If the predicate proceeds from the subject with universal logical necessity, the judgment is *analytic*; if the predicate can be joined to the subject only through a particular intuition or experience, the judgment is *synthetic* (synthetic judgments *a priori*; Kant's problem).

Inference.

The judgment must be grounded; its validity must be seen into; the act of thinking whereby the validity of one judgment is derived from one or more other judgments is a *logical inference*. If the inference has only one antecedent proposition (premise), it is called *immediate*; if it has several premises, it is called *mediate* (the requisites of inference).

The mediate inferences are divided into: the *categorical*, conditioned by the subsumption of the subordinate concept's mark (*nota notæ*) under the superordinate (syllogistic figures); the *hypothetical*, which rest on the dependence of the conditioned upon its condition (*modus ponens* and *modus tollens*); and the *disjunctive*, which are grounded on this, that the members of a whole are mutually so related that when one is expressly posited the rest are excluded (*modus ponendo tollens*), and that when the rest are excluded the one remaining must be posited (*modus tollendo ponens*).

By treating the doctrine of proof and method, formal logic resolves itself into a general doctrine of knowledge and of science.

The Immanent Logic.

The immanent logic, which is a dialectical development of the system of the categories (the thought-forms inherent in all being), divides into the doctrine of *Being*, *Essence*

and *Concept*.

Being.

Universal being is one with universal thinking; but the unity of thinking and being is, in its most abstract form, void of content: pure *Being* is the same as pure *Nothing*. But *Nothing*, as non-being, is nevertheless different from *Being*. That *Being* both is and is not *Nothing* means that *Being* unceasingly passes over into *Nothing*, and *Nothing* into *Being*: this transition is *Becoming*.

In *Becoming*, *Nothing* is a limit for *Being*, and *Being* for *Nothing*. *Being* limited by its *Nothing* is a *being*, a *Something*, and *Nothing* determined by *Being*, an *Other*. But the *Other* is itself *Something*, and *Something* in turn *Other*; *Something* passes by its own limit over into *Other*, and *Other* into *Something*: this transition is *Alteration*.

In *alteration* *Something* is one with its *Other*; this is the *Unchangeable* in the *One*; but *Something* is also different from the *Other*; this is the *Changeable* in the *One*. It is thus the *Unchangeable* that is altered; but precisely by being altered it keeps itself unaltered: under all *alteration* there is something *unchangeable*.

Essence.

The *Unchangeable* that is seen in the *Changeable* is *Essence*; the *Changeable* through which the *Essence* is seen is *Semblance*: the alternating shine of *Semblance* and *Essence* is *Reflection*.

In its identity with the *Essence*, the *Semblance* is *Phenomenon*; in its difference from the *Phenomenon*, the *Essence* is *Ground*. The *Phenomenon* goes to the ground; it belongs to *Semblance* and must be reflected into its *Essence*. But in that the *Phenomenon* receives the *Essence* for its ground, it becomes grounded and is posited as *Existence*.

Existence reflected into itself is an *existent*, a *Thing*; but the *Thing* can be reflected into itself only by reflecting its existence into other existing things: the determinations corresponding to these reflections are *Properties*.

In this mutual reflecting the things dissolve into the properties, and everything

becomes unstable. But the unstable presupposes something subsisting which cannot be dissolved, because its subsistence infinitely confirms itself in the alternation of the unstable; this subsisting something is the *Substance*, and the modes of appearance alternating in instability are the *Accidents*.

The relation between the Substance and its Accidents is a *relation of causality*: the Substance is *Cause*, the original matter; the Accidents are *Effects*. But the Cause has its substantial expression in the Effect; without Effect, no Cause: by making the Cause a Cause, the Effect is itself Substance — thus a Cause that makes the Cause an Effect.

In *Reciprocity* the Effect is Cause, and the Cause Effect; and in that all the moments of actuality contained in the Essence are, under all-sided reciprocity, developed in full totality, the Essence developed in the totality is Concept.

Concept.

The self-comprehending totality is, in its unity with itself, the *Universal*; in its difference from itself, *the Particular*; in its totalized determinateness through itself, the *Singular*.

The Concept's self-development is its *ground-division* (the Judgment). By virtue of the ground-division, the totality in its first immediate being, the Singular, is posited as the *Subject*, and the totality in the reflected form, the Universal, as the *Predicate*: the Subject is what the Predicate is; the *Singular* is the *Universal*.

But in that the Singular is comprehended as the Universal, and the Universal as the Singular, the opposed members of the concept-separation become mutually comprehended, in reciprocal determination, as the *Particular*.

The outer members of the ground-division, the *Extremes*, have thus in the Concept's self-development deposited a *middle member*, a *Medium*, in which they can be mediated. This mediation is the *Inference*.

The Concept's self-mediation through Judgment and Inference is its *Subjectivity*; the immediacy regained through the mediation is its *Objectivity*.

As immediate, existing totality the Concept is Object — and, by virtue of the ground-division, an infinite manifold of existing objects.

The objects in their outward, indifferent mutuality are *mechanical*, acting upon

one another by *pressure* and *impact*. The separation of motion and rest which herewith enters is a relative appearing of the *absolute Mechanics*, in which motion is rest, and rest motion.

Beneath the indifference of the mechanical objects there hides a *difference*, which comes to light in chemical attraction. The difference of the objects brings with it a tension, which is equalized in *the chemical product*. But the product, in which the difference is neutralized, must as the *Neutral* dissolve again into difference, and the *process* begins anew.

In the chemical process the Concept goes forth out of its own presuppositions, sublates the presuppositions in their result, in order again to sublate the result in the presuppositions. The objective Concept is now master over the material: the result anticipated in the presuppositions is *End*, the presuppositions are *Means*, the movement is *teleological*.

The teleological Concept, comprehending itself in its own elements, is a form that gives itself content, a content that gives itself form: in this its *absolute unity* of form and content, of *Subjective and Objective*, of end and means, the Concept is *Idea*.

From the outlines here set forth it will be seen how divergent the directions are. In formal logic the human being, the thinking subject, is from first to last occupied with his own acts of thought; it is the human being himself who abstracts, reflects, judges and infers. But for just that reason the thought-forms are empty forms, and the acts of thought finite, psychologically conditioned operations of the understanding. The object of thinking falls outside the thinking. Here is an insurmountable gulf between the subjective and the objective, and the thinker has only to watch that in his judgment about the things he does not come into contradiction with himself. To secure the unity of the thinkable and the possible, one holds fast to *the principle of contradiction*; but that the principle of contradiction affords no reliable guarantee of the objective validity of subjective thinking, the *antinomies* in Kant's Critique of Pure Reason have sufficiently shown.

The gulf between the subjective and the objective disappears in the immanent logic, which abstracts from the thinking subjectivity and lets Being think itself by the help of contradiction and negation. That Being is Nothing is indeed a contradiction, for Being

must necessarily exclude non-being. But the non-being that is excluded is precisely the negation that lies in Being's own concept. That the Unchangeable is changeable, that the Essence is Semblance, that the Cause is Effect, are sheer contradictions. But these contradictions make it precisely evident how the thinking that is entangled in finite representations deceives itself by keeping the content of what is outside itself. The Changeable is the Unchangeable's indwelling negation, just as the Semblance is the Essence's, and the Effect the Cause's.

Nevertheless it must not be overlooked that the immanent method of developing the matter, despite its epoch-making significance, also has its weak sides. Negation is originally a thought-determination, not a determination of being. What is can, in its immediacy, negate neither itself nor another being. Negations, contradictions and resolutions of contradictions are acts of thought which hold of what is only under the express condition that Being is thought. But in order that this condition can be fulfilled, the invoked unity of thinking and being must from the beginning be grounded upon a corresponding opposition. Pure Being is Nothing, when Being is thought; but Nothing and Being fall nonetheless each under its own sphere: Nothing under thinking, and so under the subjective; and Being under actuality, and so under the objective.

If the dispute between the two recognized points of view is not to become endless and unfruitful, a third point of view must be chosen, from which it becomes possible to reconcile the contending parties. It must then be conceded to formal logic that the thoughts proceed from a thinking subjectivity; but it must at the same time be conceded to the immanent logic that it is not a finite but an infinite thinking that comprehends existence. Formal logic must be right in this, that there is a characteristic difference between the subjective in thinking and the objective in actuality; but the logic of immanence retains its right in this, that the opposition of the subjective and the objective rests upon identity of thinking and being. It is this third point of view that is chosen in *the Logic of the Fundamental Ideas*.

As regards the origin of thoughts, only three assumptions are possible: 1) that they proceed from a finite subjectivity; 2) that they develop themselves out of universal being; 3) that they spring from an infinite, absolute subjectivity. As regards the relation between thinking and being, there are likewise only three assumptions possible: 1) that

it is a finite opposition, be it in agreement or in discord; 2) that the unity sublates the opposition; 3) that the unity grounds the opposition.

For the all-sided development of logic the three points of view here set up are necessary; but more than these three are, so far as principles are concerned, impossible.

The Logic of the Fundamental Ideas

develops the ideal essentiality of the thought-forms under *the Idea of Knowledge*, the forms of being corresponding to actuality under *the Idea of Power*, and points out the dualistic unity of the ideal and the real content in *the Idea of Truth*.

The fundamental separation of the three Ideas is especially motivated by regard to the one-sidedness of the immanent logic.

In order that thinking shall be possible, there must be something that is thought, hence something that thinking itself posits, presupposes and produces; this is *the Ideal*. But in order that actuality, the actual world, can have validity, there must be something other than thinking: something that is not thought, but about which there is thinking; something whereby thinking is determined, but which it does not itself produce; this is *the Real*. The difference between the Ideal and the Real points to a decisive difference between Knowledge and Power: the Ideal is a knowledge-determination, the Real a power-determination.

It is universally acknowledged that everything in the world must have a ground; herein lies that the existent must rest upon a non-existent. The ground by itself is not existent; it has existence only in the existence which it grounds. The ground is an *ideality*; the thing, the actual object, is a *reality*. The ideality can be thought, and there can be thinking about the reality; but the reality itself cannot be thought; to think the reality is to sublate it and transform it into ideality.

The immanent logic has shown excellently what ideality is, but it has entirely forgotten what reality is.

When the finite, the existing positive, is to hold itself abstractly, as the Real, over

against the infinite as the negative, the Ideal, then it is easy to see that the ideality must swallow up the reality. For by having the infinite as its limit, the finite itself becomes infinite; but thereby the infinite, which from its side receives the finite as its limit, becomes precisely finite. In that the opposed qualities have thus mutually negated one another, they have, by the negation of the negation, at the same time affirmed one another, and have thereby both obtained the same ideality: the finite's ideality is its sublation and confirmation in the infinite; just so the infinite's ideality is its sublation and confirmation in the finite. But the reality has vanished.

The immanent logic has an altogether false conception of reality. In its zeal to comprehend the object, it neglects to form an actual concept of the actual object. The actual object is not an ideality but a reality, a phenomenon of power, which no thinking is able to produce. Not even the divine thought would be capable of thinking an actual stone; for when the stone is thought, it is transformed into ideality and ceases to exist.

It is with respect to this that the Logic of the Fundamental Ideas has enforced the dualistic opposition of Knowledge and Power. If Power is to pass straightway into Knowledge, then it is over with the reality of existence; the things become semblance, and the actual world dissolves into a metaphysical system of divine thoughts. If Knowledge is to vanish into Power, then ideality is lost. Realism sinks down into a crude materialism, which makes the Ideal a semblance of the Real, the spiritual an empty after-glow of the corporeal.

But when all the ideal content of being is elucidated in *the Idea of Knowledge*, and the real content of actuality passes into *the Idea of Power*, then it follows of itself that the unity of the opposition must have its complete expression in the Idea of Ideas, the all-sided Idea, which saturates thinking with ideality and upholds the reality of actuality — i.e. in *the Idea of Truth*.

A. Knowledge.

a). The Concept of Knowledge.

To know something is, in indeterminate generality, to become conscious of something. Here, then, are presupposed¹: *a knowing self, an object of knowledge, and consciousness's unity of both*. In the apprehension of this unity what chiefly matters is certainty, assurance, and insight. Knowledge is the intellectual light in which selfhood-determinations and determinations of the other are united and clarified in full transparency.

α) Immediate Certainty.

Through sensing and thinking the manifold content of existence passes over into consciousness. But since thinking in its beginning is just as immediate as sensing, self-certainty and certainty of the other are originally, though in different ways, immediate.

Immediate certainty is groundless, hence unfortified, and passes involuntarily over into uncertainty. The objects alter: doubt arises about the essence of the objects. The senses can deceive; doubt arises about the testimony of the senses. Thinking develops concepts; but the partially formed concepts stand in contradiction with one another:

¹As regards the determination of philosophy's first general presupposition, one must indeed distinguish between the propaedeutic preparation and the systematic beginning. In the philosophical propaedeutic the relation between the knower and the object of knowledge is elucidated from the ever more concrete standpoints of the doctrine of cognition, the doctrine of science, and the doctrine of Ideas. (Cf. *Philosophisk Propædeutik i Grundtræk*. Kbhvn. 1857). In logic, by contrast, the point of departure is taken in pure, self-presupposing knowledge. (Cf. *Grundideernes Logik. I*. Kbhvn. 1864. Side 1–11).

doubt arises about the validity of thinking (scepticism²).

In order that certainty may be won back through uncertainty, there is required

β) Assurance.

On the basis of immediate certainty, self-certainty was presupposed without further ado, and there developed, in the clear light of immediacy, a manifold knowledge of the other (the world of objects and representations). But doubt came and darkened the clarity. Doubt, which dissolves knowledge and confuses consciousness, begins by undermining the certainty of the world of objects and ends by attacking self-certainty. But in its attack on self-certainty doubt dissolves itself and perishes in renewed certainty. Even if the doubter could doubt everything (*de omnibus dubitandum est*), he could nevertheless not possibly doubt his own doubting. Doubt is thinking, and the self is thinking (*cogito ergo sum*); it is, in its self-thinking, assured of its own being. But thereby it becomes at the same time assured of the being of things.

From self-assurance follows the assurance of the subjective validity of the original selfhood-forms (the pure intuitions, categories, and Ideas) (Kant); but from this follows also the assurance of their objective validity. If there could be otherness-forms, determinations of being in the thing in itself (das Ding an sich), which by their nature stood in conflict with the original selfhood-forms, then it would be not merely impossible for us, but impossible in itself, to have a knowledge of the essence of things; for not a single determination can be taken up into knowledge without the knowing self having to produce it. This holds not only of thoughts but also of sense-impressions, not only of concepts but also of images and representations.

Judging by immediate experience, one would indeed suppose that from the world of things there were conveyed to consciousness countless object-forms and property-determinations which did not in the least concern its own essence. Yet upon some reflection it will readily appear that nothing can be known except that which is determined in knowledge. How should there be a knowledge of colour if the knowing being did not itself have something to do with colour.

²On the sceptical dialectic cf. Phil. Propæd. Side 152–154; Grundid. Log. II. 212–222.

To appeal to visual organs and light-impressions is in this connection of no significance, for the fundamental question is how the organically conditioned light-impression is transformed into consciousness of light, or how a colour-determination can become a knowledge-determination. Could the light from without shine through the organ into the soul, as through a prism it can fall upon the wall of the chamber, then the colours would indeed be able to colour consciousness, so that it became both yellow and blue.

γ) Insight.

Through assurance the lost clarity is regained in the form of clearing-up, grounding, and explanation, and corresponds to insight. The knower's insight is double: it is an insight into the matter with its members and relations, and it is an insight into the proper essence of the thinking consciousness. Just as thinking of the other is essentially self-thinking, so all thorough understanding of the other is conditioned by self-understanding. Logical self-understanding rests on the insight that the forms of reflection, judgment, and inference are universally valid otherness-forms because they are original and necessary selfhood-forms.

The knowing subjectivity is in its self-knowledge a reflecting being. Immediately, reflecting is a mirroring, and presupposes a mirroring activity and a mirror-image: pure knowledge is, in the intellectual sense, pure mirroring. That the subjective activity is mirroring makes it explicable that what is mirrored can remain standing in the form of otherness without melting together with the determining selfhood-form — that colour-images, for example, can be mirrored by consciousness and awaken consciousness of colours without colouring consciousness. But so long as mirroring is apprehended only as immediate reflecting, this reflecting will fit otherness just as well as selfhood. In optics there are many mirrors and many kinds of mirrorings; but logically understood, the original reflecting is an ideal self-activity, a thinking. Things cannot reflect, for they cannot think; on the other hand, not only can their essence be thought upon, but this essence can be reflected in itself when it is reflected in subjectivity: all reflection of the other rests on self-reflection.

The knowing subjectivity is in its self-knowledge a judgment; herein lies the

ground of the judgment's form being an essential otherness-form. Subjectivity is a judgment, that is, it is a subject whose predicates are determined by the functions corresponding to its judgments. "The self is seeing, is hearing, is thinking"; by the predicate "seeing" are determined all judgments about visible things, by the predicate "hearing" about audible ones, by the predicate "thinking" about thinkable ones. From this it follows that in every possible judgment, whether the self for the rest judges about the other or about itself, there must be a double subject, the judgment's and the judger's, and likewise a double predicate and a double copula: the otherness-form in the judgment is infinitely reflected in the selfhood-form.

The knowing subjectivity is in its self-knowledge an inference; herein lies the ground of the inference-form being an essential otherness-form. The inference arises — so far as one looks to what is typical — in that the judgment's subject and predicate, according to their difference of totality, form extremes whose unity cannot immediately be indicated by the copula but must be mediated by a middle term.

The selfhood-judgments declare, namely, that heterogeneous predicates, belonging to different spheres, are posited in one and the same subject. In seeing, the subject is the seer; in hearing, it is the hearer; the seer is thus hearing, and the hearer seeing; the sensing one is thinking, and the thinking one sensing. Raised above the difference of the knowledge-functions, the self holds itself fast as the singular. And yet the self is in itself a particular, for sensing is something other than thinking; what is thought is not sensed: the sensing one is thus not the thinking one, or: the sensing and the thinking self are particular. Further, sight is something other than hearing; what is seen cannot be heard, and what is heard cannot be seen: the seer is thus not the hearer, or: the seeing and the hearing self are particular.

Now by such a division the self would be split asunder if the division were not a self-division that let itself be equalized in the universal. But the self is itself this equalization.

The self divides itself into its functions; but these functions, however heterogeneous they may be, are yet all selfhood-functions, and, as selfhood-functions, functions of one another mutually.

If in sensing there were not a hidden thinking, the sensing self could distinguish

nothing, and consequently could not sense: sensing is thus a function of thinking. Conversely, if in thinking there were not an implied sensing, there would be no element of representation, and the thinking self could distinguish nothing, and consequently could not think: thinking is thus a function of sensing. One distinguishes in sensing by the help of thinking, and one distinguishes in thinking by the help of sensing. That there is distinguishing is the universal; that which under the universal distinguishing is separated and distinguished is the particular. The distinguisher is in its distinguishing equal to itself: the self that distinguishes itself in everything and everything in itself is thus the particular because it is the universal.

Apprehended immediately for itself, the self is the singular. In this its singularity it is a fixed point, an atom, from which activities go forth in all directions. To this attaches the representation of an existent thing, a soul-real (Herbart); but such a representation makes the self selfless.

Apprehended immediately in the form of particularity, the self is a swarm of selfhood-points: it is the centre of the whole circle, but every point in the circle is in turn a centre. This monstrous contradiction stems not from particularity, but from the immediacy in which the particular is held fast. The dissolution of immediacy in infinite reflection is the solution of the contradiction. The self is reflected in its singularity, for its activity as a singular is, by means of the particular, a self-activity. It is reflected in its particularity, for its particular activity is, by means of its singularity, a self-activity: self-activity = self-activity is the universal in which the self consists.

Knowledge is not activity, but the light in the universal activity, the infinite reflecting and mirroring. The universal activity, an activity of activity into the infinite, is in its formal generality an empty concept. The essence that is universal in the absolute sense is thus self-essence only in that the singular and the particular, each for itself in mutual opposition, is self-essence.

Where then is the self in this essence? It is in its own inference. When the singular and the particular are posited as extremes, the middle is the universal (S—U—P); when the singular and the universal are posited as extremes, the middle is the particular (S—P—U); when finally the particular and the universal are posited as extremes, the middle is the singular (U—S—P). The self has subsistence in a system of inferences:

the inference-unity, the absolute central unity, is itself the eternal beginning-unity.

From this standpoint it will now be possible to attain insight into the relation between the logical fundamental forms of selfhood and of otherness.

In the essence of knowledge they are the same forms; the opposition rests solely on reflection's position toward the immediate. In the selfhood-forms immediacy is completely dissolved; but in the forms of otherness the immediate constantly returns and interrupts reflection. Otherness cannot reflect itself; it must be reflected by selfhood.

As object for the self, that which is is itself a something for itself. That it is something for itself points to selfhood; and yet something is for itself only what it is in its relation to an other. But something passes over into an other only so far as it is thought together with the other; its transition is no self-movement — the movement is in the thinking subjectivity. Something reflects itself in an other only in that the self reflects upon something and other: in becoming and alteration the otherness-reflection shows itself expressly as the intellectual product and counter-image of self-reflection.

Otherness-being is becoming. If that which is is reflected in its own becoming, and conversely: then immediacy is sublated; then that which is is essence, and that which becomes, semblance. As essence and semblance reflect themselves in one another, it looks as though the essence itself thought its semblance, and the semblance its essence; but the thought-movement goes on in the thinker. The reflection of semblance and essence is self-reflection's own reflection of the other. That the reflection-form, essential in itself, is an otherness-form is seen also from this, that the essence's reflection into itself is posited as thing, and its reflection into an other as property: the thing itself is selfless, and the property a quality of the selfless.

But the selfless must necessarily acquire a semblance of selfhood; otherwise the otherness-forms could not possibly become knowledge-forms. The knowing self then knows that the concept of the thing's being is a judgment. The thing now becomes subject, and the property its predicate. The subject is its predicate: it looks in otherness quite as in selfhood. But in the essence of otherness the selfhood is semblance; the thing, the selfless subject, has no true subjectivity; the subjectivity lies on the surface, for it lies in the properties.

By making the world of things into a world of judgments, the judging self knows how to hold things together and to comprehend the unity of connection in a system of inferences. Unity of connection is determined by relation, relation by reflection, reflection by judgment, judgment by inference: the articulated reciprocal determinations of the forms of selfhood and otherness yield the fundamental moments in the concept of knowledge.

b) Finite Knowledge.

According to the concept of knowledge, self-knowledge and knowledge of the other must necessarily presuppose each other into the infinite; but in the special development they part company, and herein finitude is seen. The distinguishing mark is that the knowledge-content which saturates the selfhood-forms and is necessary for their logical unfolding is poor, empty, and formal in comparison with the content that fills the forms of otherness with their outwardly infinite wealth. The strict, systematic deduction of the original I-hood propositions, as it has been carried through in subjective idealism (Fichte), is a telling example of the a priori poverty of pure self-knowledge. In contrast, the doctrine of experience has such a superabundance of content-determinations and objective knowledge-forms that along this path there can be no question of demonstrating the necessity with which the facts of the objective world proceed, member by member, from the subjective fundamental demands of the I-essence (nature-philosophical mysticism; Schelling).

In order to make the relation of finitude clear, we note especially: first the one-sidedness of a priori knowledge, then that of empirical knowledge, and thereby come to see the necessity of the logical dissolution of finite knowledge.

α) A priori Knowledge.

Formal logic's conception of the principle of identity and contradiction finds its most adequate application in the science that is precisely suited to make intelligible the finitude of a priori knowledge, namely mathematics. The equation: $A = A$, is in the objective sense what the self-proposition: $I = I$, is in the subjective; likewise the

proposition: A is not Not-A, in the form of otherness, has as its presupposition the proposition: I am not Not-I, in the form of self-limitation. Here is immanent reflection of the subjective and the objective.

Further, a hypothetical proposition such as this — if $\frac{a}{b} = \frac{c}{x}$, then $x = \frac{bc}{a}$ — can serve as an example that objective relation is grounded in subjective reflection. From the antecedent the consequent must necessarily follow; the relation between a, b, c, and x is so far objective. But the magnitudes have not themselves set themselves in relation to one another; a has not itself divided itself by b, nor c by x. The relation is posited by the reflecting subjectivity. In the quotients $\frac{a}{b}$ and $\frac{c}{x}$, a is reflected in b, and b in a, c in x, and x in c; the numerator presupposes a looking to the denominator, and the denominator to the numerator: that is subjective reflection. If an equation such as $\frac{dy}{dx} = c$ is chosen, the numerator is no immediate term, but a reflex of a magnitude vanished in vanishing, and the same holds of the denominator dx; as the two reflexes are reflected in each other and form the quotient, the reflection becomes objective; but it is only objective because it is subjective.

Could the mathematical development now be continued in such wise that to every new objective relation there corresponded a new and fruitful insight into subjective reflection, to every new theorem a new and fruitful cognition of subjectivity's original self-positing: then we should here have a method (*methodus mathematica*) which was in an eminent degree suited to sublimate the finitude of a priori knowledge.

But this reckoning does not suffice. It is true, indeed, that propositions such as, A is A, A is not Not-A, belong so intimately to general self-thinking that their validity is evident to every thinker. But whence comes it that equations such as $\log A^x = x \log A$, d. $\sqrt{a^2 - x^2} = \frac{-x dx}{\sqrt{a^2 - x^2}}$, even when the notations are explained one by one, cannot be said to belong to the original comprehension of the self, are not indispensable for logical self-understanding? Nay, whence comes it that mathematics cannot be deduced from metaphysics, or conversely? It comes from this, that a priori knowledge, on account of finitude, parts into two one-sided directions: a logical-dialectical one, which immerses itself in self-reflections, and an exact-operating one, which loses itself in reflections of the other³.

³On the difference between reflection-concepts and operation-concepts cf. *Mathematik og Dialektik*. Kjøbenhavn. 1859. S. 40—56.

β) Empirical Knowledge.

The a priori otherness-forms that are articulated in the pure analyses of magnitude rest solely on phantasy-intuitions and representations, and the represented otherness falls, so far, still within selfhood.

But when it is a question of a knowledge of existing things, the contradiction enters that the objects within knowledge themselves fall outside knowledge. The finite consciousness has, namely, a world of objects *outside* itself; but it cannot possibly have a knowledge of these objects except by taking their being up into itself, and thus having them *within* itself. This contradiction, hidden in the foundation of empirical knowledge, conditions the manifoldness of cognition, but at the same time betrays its finitude under the form of contingency.

The contingency is subjective, for the universally necessary otherness-forms in which the objects must be apprehended can indeed be had in consciousness without knowledge that the special objects really exist. That an existent object must always correspond to some concept or other, that is, to some filling-out or other of a priori forms, does not sublate the contingency, since such a filling-out can take place in countless ways: that many and different things bear the same name points precisely to the differences being regarded as contingent. The empirical concept to which the name answers repeats itself in a multitude of corresponding specimens; on the basis of the concept the specimen is described, but the pictorial elements of the description indicate the contingency.

In relation to the individuals and the immediately individual, the existent concept is the species, and the nearest universal concept of the particular species is the genus. That an individual with one or more marks of a certain species must have all the marks belonging to the species is inferred by *analogy*; that essential determinations which are decisive for some individuals belonging to a certain species or genus must hold for them all is inferred by *induction*; but since not only the individuals but also the concepts are empirical, both induction and analogy are burdened with a moment of contingency that can transform certainty into uncertainty.

From a general standpoint empirical knowledge can indeed attain reliable certainty; but the particular cases constantly cross the universal and call forth uncertainty. The

ground of assurance is negative: “here is no case that breaks with the universal established by the observations; ergo this universal, determining the cases, is a law.” But the universal thus established is nevertheless, in its positive form, empirical. To the methodically continued observations the world of experience constantly presents new sides, new relations, new properties, new laws.

The contingency is objective, for it is not merely we who must alter, correct, and improve our concepts of things; the concepts themselves (species and genera; Darwin) alter by degrees, in that, as existence-concepts, they alter the existential expression with the alterations of the individuals. The contingency is objective, for the existence of the objects is independent of our subjective knowledge of them. We could not sense the objects if the objects did not sensibly exist; but the sensible objects can very well exist without our sensing them. We form for ourselves concepts that are abstracted from the objects, but the objects themselves are indifferent to our abstracting and comprehending. It lies in the independence of the objects to have our knowledge of them outside themselves as a contingency.

For our finite knowledge, then, the world of things stands as a barrier, an impenetrable other. We cognize, says the doctrine of experience, the properties of things, but not the things themselves; we cognize the laws, but not the essence. Mechanics does not know what force is; chemical physics does not know what electricity is; physiology does not know what life is. True empirical knowledge has everywhere taken up into its foundations the determination: not-knowledge.

γ) The Dissolution of Finite Knowledge.

The contradictions with which finite knowledge is burdened on all sides gather at last into the one: omniscience is necessary and yet incomprehensible. That omniscience is necessary shines forth from the original essence of knowledge. For since all determinations of existence are, in the logical sense, knowledge-determinations, and all knowledge-determinations functions of the knowing self: nothing whatever can be known except that alone which is produced by knowledge.

The contradiction is now this, that finite knowledge everywhere in the actual world finds before it object-forms which neither it itself nor the object has produced.

All outward things exist in space. But what is space? An extension produced by intuiting, existing for intuition. In intuiting the things in space, we intuit them in a previously intuited form (objective space); and the same holds of time.

By reflecting on the objects existing in space and time, we come to a similar result. For us, with our finite knowledge, the intuitable objects exist before we intuit them. But intuitable is only that which is produced by intuiting. Our intuiting is determined by the intuitable, that which is already produced. How has the object become intuitable? Solely in that its existence is posited in an intuitable form, i.e. in a form possible for intuition; but an object-form possible for intuition is actual only in virtue of an original intuiting that forms the object.

For the original intuiting, the object itself is reflected as image, and the image as object. In the form of the image, however, the object-reflection is superficial; the essential content has its exhaustive form in the concept. For our knowledge it is the object that determines the concept; but in the matter itself it is the concept that determines the object. In order to determine the object, the concept must beforehand be determined by a comprehending independent of our concept, hence by a knowledge independent of our knowledge.

The intuiting, thinking, and comprehending of omniscience, in which existence should have its original ground, is indeed incomprehensible from the standpoint of finitude (simultaneous and successive knowledge; intuitive and discursive knowledge;⁴ knowledge's relative and absolute limit); but as omniscience in represented form is incomprehensible to finite knowledge, finite knowledge becomes at the same time incomprehensible to itself: in order to comprehend itself, finite knowledge must recognize its dissolution in the infinite.

c) The Infinite Knowledge.

So far as the original knowledge is immediately apprehended as omniscience, it looks as though it were only a boundless extension of man's restricted knowledge: "Man knows something, the learned man knows much, but God knows everything." This

⁴Cf. Grundrid. Log. I. S. 230–63.

conception is unscientific. The concept of infinite knowledge cannot be formed by sublating the limit of the finite; for when the limit falls away, everything runs together into one. The fundamental difference between finite and infinite knowledge rests on a thoroughgoing difference between *restricting* and *indwelling* limits.

Finite knowledge has that which limits it outside itself, because the finite self has its other, its actual opposite, outside itself; our self-knowledge is in its finitude separated from our knowledge of the other; in its formal circular movement it has only the shadow of the infinite, not infinity itself. The divine self, on the other hand, has its other, its actual opposite, in its own essence: for this self-knowledge the immediate *outside* is essentially an *inside*. The infinity of knowledge shows itself in reflection, in judgment, in inference.

α) The Infinity of Reflection.

The sensible is the immediate other for sensing; likewise the thinkable is an other for thinking. If now this sensible and thinkable other is apprehended as outward limit, as barrier, the sensing-thinking consciousness gets a world of sensible-thinkable objects outside itself.

Dazzled by this outside of immediacy, finite knowledge then assumes that the sensible stands beforehand fully finished and merely waits to be sensed. This waiting, then, signifies no lack or essential want. If the sensing comes, well and good; the sensible takes no harm from it, suffers nothing under it: it willingly permits the senser to apply his apprehension, for it is indeed there to be sensed, it is indeed sensible. But if the sensing does not come, that too is well; the sensible has all the same its complete determinations of being, its pronounced actuality-forms in itself. And as it goes with the sensible in things, so it goes also with the thinkable. This way of seeing is a telling proof of the restriction of finite knowledge.

Sensible and sensing, thinkable and thinking, are correlate concepts. What, indeed, is the sensible for itself? It is an indeterminate that must let itself be determined — by sensing. If the sensible is held fast in all its indeterminacy, it is not an existent; for everything existent is a determinate being: what is still indeterminate does not exist in actuality, it is only a possibility. The sensible is a possibility, namely for sensing,

a possibility of sensing, just as the thinkable is a possibility of thinking. Outside all sensing and thinking, the objects are, not merely for us but also in themselves, indeterminable magnitudes, pure possibilities without any actuality.

But now the converse holds as well, that sensing for itself is only a possibility for the sensible, and thinking for itself a possibility for the thinkable. Where there is nothing sensible there can be no sensing, and where there is nothing thinkable there can be no thinking. To sense a nothing is impossible; and when thinking thinks its nothing, its negation, this nothing is itself, by virtue of the word, a thinkable that acquires existence for thought. The two possibilities, that of sensing and that of the sensible, corresponding to that of thinking and that of the thinkable, are in knowledge one and the same possibility; they are actualized through each other; they stand and fall with each other: they must either both become actual or both impossible.

If now it is incontestably certain that all sensing must have a sensible, and all thinking a thinkable, for its possibility; if it is evident from the matter itself that the sensible can become actually determined only by the determining sensing, and the thinkable only by the determining thinking: then this is to say, in other words, that the sensible-thinkable objects are indwelling limits, real-negations in the proper essence of sensing and thinking. As real-negation the sensible-thinkable steps forth with object-like immediacy, and so far there is here an actual *outside*; but since this immediacy, under all turns, in all alterations of form, is only the real-negation's own appearing, the actual outside is everywhere, in knowledge's infinite reflection, essentially an *inside*.

β) The Infinity of Judgment.

Sensing is not thinking, and the sensible is not a thinkable; and yet sensing is possible only through thinking, the sensible possible only by means of the thinkable: sensing is at bottom thinking, and the sensible thinkable. Both determinations — both that sensing is not and yet is thinking, and that the sensible is not and yet is thinkable — are taken up into the infinite reflection; but in order to solve the contradiction contained therein, reflection must be expressly determined by the judgment.

The categorical judgment: "The subject is (essentially) its predicate," receives its

fullest expression in the concrete form: "The individual is its species." All determinations belonging to the individual are sensible; all marks answering to the species as species, on the other hand, thinkable: the individual is sensed, the species is thought; thus the judgment expresses at once the difference between sensible and thinkable and at the same time the unity.

The finite knowledge, restricted by its *outside*, cannot however come to clarity with itself concerning the relation between subject and predicate. It looks as though the individual, the sensible, were properly the first and original, and the species, the thinkable, on the contrary the derived; for the judging subjectivity must indeed set out from a sensible apprehension of the individual and then abstract the species from the individual. Thus the existent individual is *outside*, the abstracted species-concept on the contrary *inside*, consciousness.

But if this relation is the properly true one, then it must be the individual that determines the species, while thinking on its side maintains that it is the species that determines the individual. Sensing asserts that the individual is the original, the species the derived; thinking asserts that the species is the original, the individual the derived: here is tension and strife between sensing and thinking.

In the infinity of the judgment the contradiction is solved in that the two factors, the sensible and the thinkable, are both taken up as moments in one and the same essential fundamental factor, namely in the selfhood-act whereby the judging subjectivity has originally posited the judgment's content in the judgment's form.

It is, then, just as little the abstract concept, the species, that produces the individual, as it is the immediately existent individual that yields the species-concept. The individual's existence has the species as its ground, so that the species, the content of thinking, grounds and determines the object of sensing, the individual. And why? Because the sensible is from the ground up contained in the thinkable, because thinking in the original judgment-act rests precisely on sensing, just as conversely sensing on thinking.

In the finite judgment-act the moments fall apart from one another: the individual, the judgment's subject, is found for itself as a sensible object; then thinking steps in, abstracts the species-marks, and determines the predicate; then it looks as though the

individual fell outside the judgment and remained indifferent to the whole judgment-act; then the judgment-act has significance only for the judging subject, not for the subject in the judgment. It is a parcelling-out that characterizes finitude.

In the infinite judgment-act, on the other hand, the moments are gathered in one comprehending into one concept. In this knowledge-concept sensing is infinitely articulated by thinking, the sensible by the thinkable, the outward by the inward: the piecework is sublated, but the particularity of the members, the difference of the moments, are all preserved in the unity of transparency.

The disjunctive judgment: “A is either B or C,” is in formal logic a schema, an empty form, which can take up from without many kinds of content. It receives its fullest content through the determination of the relation between species and genus. The genus A is either the species B or the species C, and so on. Formal logic, which places the judgment-act down in the finite subjectivity, now conceives the relation between the genus and its species in such wise that the genus-concept has the lesser content because it has the greater extension, while the converse holds of the species-concept. According to the immanent logic it is, on the contrary, the genus which contains the species within itself. The genus-concept is then determined as the content-rich concept, the concrete universal concept, in which the species with their one-sidednesses complete one another. This conception has certainly aimed at the form of infinity; but the unovercome finitude shows through, for the form cannot logically master its content.

As the concrete-universal, namely, the genus-concept should itself comprehend its species-concepts; it should, without giving up its own content-rich unity, part with the species and set them so exclusively against one another that each species for itself excluded the rest. But that is impossible. If the separation of the species is in earnest, the genus-concept loses its concrete content, and formal logic proves right. If the genus is absolutely to have the same content as the species, this can happen only in one of two ways: either the particularity of the species must be equalized in the generality of the genus, and then the species perish in the genus; or else the universal as genus-concept must exhaust its content in the particular species, and then the genus perishes in the species. The judgment demands a judgment-act whereby

both things happen, but in such wise that the contradiction is solved.

Such a judgment-act no genus-concept can consummate. The genus-concept is subject in the judgment; but it is not judging subject. The infinity of the judgment is grounded in the judging subjectivity's infinite judgment-act: 1) the content laid out in the predicate is and remains the subject's content; as the judgment's subject, the genus-concept reflected into itself has the whole undivided, undiminished content of the species-differences in its own universal form; for precisely in this universal form it is subject. 2) The ground-division in the predicate is carried through in such wise that each member has in particular form the whole subject-content; each species is a particular expression of the whole genus; 3) finally, the opposition of subject and predicate is completely preserved in the unity determined by the judgment-act. Thus the judgment's members and moments are posited apart from one another, and yet they are in one another: every outside is an inside.

γ) The Infinity of Inference: the Idea of Knowledge.

As the judgments are, so must the inferences drawn from them also be. Just as the difference between finite and infinite knowledge has, as regards the judgment, been determined by the judgment-act, so it is now, as regards the inference, to be determined by the inference-act.

The immanent logic has, by dialectical presentation of the concept's trilogical determinateness as: *the Universal*, *the Particular*, and *the Singular*, certainly given the inference a form that suits the absolute content, hence the Idea. But the ambiguity of the form-development lies hidden under an ambiguous conception of the inference-act. For an inference can no more infer itself than a judgment can judge itself, or a concept comprehend itself. The self that comprehends itself in all concepts is in its self-comprehending raised above every concept, in its self-judging above every judgment, in its self-inferring above every inference. But precisely for that reason this original, unoriginated self is the essential source of all concepts, all judgments, all inferences.

So long as one, as in formal logic, lets the psychologically restricted subjectivity carry out the inference-act in all inferences, or, as in the immanent logic, abstracts

from finitude by abstracting from the inferring subjectivity, so long can one go on reducing and transforming the inference-forms as much as one will: one never comes to clear insight into the Idea of Knowledge.

The old strife about genera and species (γένη and εἶδη), whether they are Ideas or abstract concepts, cannot be settled in finite knowledge. But the finitude of knowledge persists so long as it has not yet been brought to full consciousness that the infinity of the inference is the Idea's logical form, and that this infinity rests decisively on the infinite inference-act.

The individual in sensible immediacy is indeed no Idea; but a concept in abstract intellectual form, whether for the rest it be a species-concept or a genus-concept, is no Idea either. That pure sensing cannot apprehend the Idea is certain; but that pure thinking — das Denken des Denkens im allgemeinen Denken — likewise cannot apprehend the Idea is also certain. To regard the substantial universal forms as self-valid realities and the individuals as fleeting phenomena (*universalia ante rem*) conflicts with the Idea of Knowledge just as much as to place the whole reality in the individual and reduce the universal forms to empty names (*nomina, flatus vocis*). The original relation between the universal forms and the individuals can be determined solely by the inference-act.

If it depended merely on setting up an inference-schema such as this: the individual is the genus by means of the species (S—P—U), the species is the genus by means of the individual (P—S—U), the individual is the species by means of the genus (S—U—P): then Idea-cognition would be not only the easiest but also the most superficial of all scientific cognitions. The task first comes into view when one reflects on what such an inference-schema essentially means.

The schema set up means, namely, that of the inference's three members — individual, species, and genus — none is the first and none the last, but that all three must have the same originality.

The sum of sense-determinations gathered in the unity of the individual is determined beforehand by the totality of thought-determinations contained in the species; but this thought-content is in turn a modified form of the universal content of the genus-concept. So the formation of the genus-concept would accordingly be the

unconditioned first. But the formation of the genus-concept presupposes precisely the species-concept, and this in turn the individual; so the individual would accordingly be the unconditioned first after all. Here is the contradiction. The individual cannot be formed before the species and the genus are formed; for, *seen in the Idea, the individual is the immediate inference-unity of species and genus*. The species cannot be formed before the individual and the genus are formed; for, *seen in the Idea, the species is the reflected inference-unity of genus and individual*. Finally, the genus is *itself, determined as Idea, the comprehended inference-unity of species and individual*, and must expressly have the two extremes as its premises.

It is then surely evident that the inference-system which is to express the Idea's content in the form of knowledge must spring from one single threefold inference-act, and that no psychologically limited subjectivity is in a position to carry out such an act.

Logical insight into the infinity of the inference, and a corresponding formal insight into the Idea's original essentiality — hence a knowledge of the Absolute — is made possible by the dialectical dissolution of finite knowledge in the infinite; but such a knowledge of the Absolute is infinitely far from being an absolute knowledge.

To have a knowledge of the Absolute that is true in the formal respect is to have an absolute assurance that all determinations of being are originally knowledge-determinations, that the light of knowledge is the essence of things, that the content of the whole existing world is grounded and borne by infinite, i.e. by divine, knowledge.

B. Power.

a) The Essence of Power.

Although all being comes in under knowledge, there is nevertheless in actual existence an other, namely the immediate object-being, which forms an opposition to knowledge; this other, this opposition-determination, has from the standpoint of infinity hitherto been apprehended only as indwelling limit-determination, as real-negation.

If the otherness-limit, the real negation, which makes the knowledge-determination into a reflected object-determination, did not — precisely on account of otherness's own essence — part itself into a manifold of negations and object-reflexes, the knowledge-concepts would melt together into an empty semblance, and the unbroken light in the Idea of Knowledge would be differenceless, like pure darkness.

But a negation is impossible where there is nothing that can be negated; every negation is originally a negation of something positive: that the negation of the negation yields a positive determination means that the positive, whose immediacy was sublated in the first negation, returns with the second. The indwelling real-negations of the Idea of Knowledge thus presuppose a corresponding manifold of immediate object-positions — an expression of the essence of power.

α) Negative and Positive in the Essence of Power.

Were it possible to hold fast the negative for itself without the positive, and conversely, one would now be able to separate knowledge and power thus: the essence of existence — the thought-content reflected in negative determinations, negatively affirmed through negations and negations of negations — comes in under knowledge; actual

existence — the object-world existing in positive determinations, unfolding itself in immediate positions — comes on the contrary under power; in other words: the world of concepts (*mundus intelligibilis*) has its subsistence in knowledge; the material world of things (*mundus sensibilis*) has its subsistence in power. In this way it would then come to look as though power were joined on to knowledge, and actuality to essence.

That such a compounding of knowledge and power is hollow and contradictory is understood of itself.

The positive is indeed qualitatively different from the negative; but this difference is precisely grounded in the unity of the essence. The same essence that negates must also be able to posit, for otherwise the negation could not sublate the position, could not be essential negation; conversely: the same essence that posits must itself be able to negate, for in the contrary case the negation of the negation could not possibly become any true and actual position. This the immanent logic has developed to convincing clarity, and all later attempts to hold the absolutely positive sharply separated from the negative (Herbart) have shown themselves invalid and fruitless.

But then the immanent logic has in turn committed a great blunder, in that it has without further ado let the negating and positing essence be absorbed both in its negations and in its positions. If the negating essence is completely absorbed in its negation, then the negative negates itself, independently of the position; if the positing essence is immediately absorbed in its position, then the positive posits itself, independently of the negation; in this way the one and the same essence would, in spite of the principle of immanence, split into two independent essences, a negating and a positing one. If the negating essence is itself to be positing, it cannot, on account of the position, be absorbed in the negation, and just as little, on account of the negation, be absorbed in the position; if it is to be sunk in the infinite alternation of positions and negations, then, strictly taken, it does not even become the ground of all that becomes; it becomes process of process, real becoming pure and simple, a becoming that is not essence.

If the opposition of negation and position is to be thinkable as proceeding from the same essence, then this all-negating, all-positing essence must be a self-essence raised above its negations and positions; only such a self-essence is capable, by sublation of

barriers in the other (the immediately positive), of affirming itself through negations in knowledge, and, by negation of negations, of affirming its other outwardly through positions in power. The outward-going affirmation, the affirmation of the other, is then actuality's measure of the self-affirmation, the inward-going affirmation: the indwelling capability of this double-sided affirmation deposits

β) Extremes in the Essence of Power.

Power is essence, be it noted, in the form of actuality, developed to absolute necessity. Categories such as: force, possibility, condition, and existence form the development's abstract logical basis. Force, regarded as possibility, is condition for the manifestation, and the manifestation is the existence that results where the condition takes place; but necessity is the activity which, by completing the reflection and sublating the condition, leads the existent back to immediate being. The necessary is indeed necessary by means of an other, which is its condition, and this condition is itself existing or independent; but since the necessary does not itself come to existence before the condition's existence is sublated, the necessary is just as much unconditioned, or: it is because it is. In this unconditionedness the necessary makes itself immediately felt as power. — From this standpoint the concept of power is apprehended in the immanent logic.

But what has cognition now gained by such a conception? A dialectical demonstration of the place which, according to scientific usage, belongs to the category: power, among the other logical categories; nothing else. But what was to be attained here is something quite different; here, namely, an insight was to be attained into how actual being relates itself to thinking, or, still more definitely, how the existing thing relates itself to its concept.

The problem of *thing* and *concept* the immanent logic is so far from having solved that it has not even been able to set it up. But that here there really is a problem can be seen from this, that here there is a contradiction.

The contradiction is that thing and concept both are the same and yet are not the same. They are the same; for there can no more be thought any decisive peculiarity in the thing that should not belong to its concept, than there can be assumed in the

thing's concept any determination that does not belong to the thing; and yet they are not the same, for the thing is sensible, but the concept is non-sensible. They are the same, for concept and thing have the same content; and yet they are not the same, for the concept, the universal, has an infinitely greater extension than the thing, the singular (one concept can be in many things). They are the same, for the existing thing is the concept's existence; and yet not the same, for the existing thing is no concept, and the concept no existing thing (a stone is no concept, and the stone's concept is no stone). One can crush a stone, but not the stone's concept; one can boil a plant, but not the plant's concept; one can ride on a horse, but not on the horse's concept. When the thing is posited, its concept is sublated; when the concept is posited, the thing is sublated, or: position of the concept is negation of the thing, and position of the thing is negation of the concept.

So there is required here an essence-doubling which from the ground up makes the opposition of thing and concept intelligible, in that it at the same time makes the unity of the opposition intelligible.

For the concept, the first extreme, we have knowledge; for the thing's immediate reality, the second extreme, power; the middle, the unity of the extremes, is self-unity: the knowing self is powerful, the powerful self knowing; the powerful knowledge is, in the unity of the inference, an ideal capability, the knowing power a real one.

The inference-unity, the original capability from which the extremes go forth and in which they subsist, is an active unity; its being is activity, and its activity an infinite converting of concept into existence, of existence into concept.

The conversion takes place by a leap, for the concept is qualitatively different from the thing: the concept cannot be condensed into thing, and the thing cannot be thinned out into concept. But it is a leap whereby nothing is leapt over; for power without knowledge, blind power, is just as much a semblance as knowledge without power. The concept that has absorbed power in the form of knowledge is a powerful concept, a concept that is capable of determining the thing; conversely, the thing determined by the concept is an expression of knowledge in the form of power, a concept uttered in existence.

Since now the knowledge impregnated with power, by its negative form, deprives

power of all immediacy, transforms it into logical capacity, into intellectual capability: it makes power invisible, posits the concept and sublates the thing. The power impregnated with knowledge-determinations, on the other hand, interrupts the reflection; it sublates thinking by its immediate, positive form; it takes the concept up into real capability and brings the capacity's logical tension to antilogical discharge — that is, it posits the thing and sublates the concept.

γ) The Logical-Antilogical in the Essence of Power.

The concept can be thought, but the thing cannot be thought; the concept can be uttered in words, but the thing's existential determinateness is unutterable: the concept is logical, the thing is antilogical.

It is indeed assumed without further ado that it is immediately the thing that is thought, and that the word exactly expresses what the thing is; but that is a deception which the logical judgment occasions. What now is This? This is This, and yet the pointing designation can expressly show that This is not This; for This, for example, is a house, but This is a horse, and This is in turn another This. By pointing to the object the word points away from the word, the thought away from the thought: this is the antilogical.

The antilogical stands over against the logical as the object stands over against its concept; but just for that reason the antilogical can no more be either illogical or in contradiction with the logical, than the object can be either concept-less or in contradiction with its concept. The unity is that the object and the concept have, as far as the essence is concerned, the same determinations; but the opposition is that the object-determinations are antilogical, the concept-determinations on the other hand logical.

That the same essential determination which in the form of thinking is logical can in the form of actuality be antilogical, every judgment about existing things proves. The existence-judgment can no more dispense with the antilogical than it can dispense with the logical. If the antilogical is placed in the subject and the logical in the predicate, the thing is judged to be concept, the for-itself unthinkable to be thinkable, and the judgment is logical (This is a rose). If conversely the logical is

placed in the subject and the antilogical in the predicate, then the concept is judged to be thing, the thinkable to be unthinkable, and the judgment is antilogical (The rose, the concept, is This, the specimen).

The immanent logic treats the actuality-concepts without further ado as pure knowledge-concepts; that is a great error. The actuality-concepts are power-concepts, recognizable by this, that the antilogical everywhere breaks forth out of the reflection and exchanges thought for fact. Categories such as: actuality, substance, cause, etc., are logical only so far as they are at the same time antilogical. Actuality is a concept, but the concept is no actuality; substance is a concept, but the concept is no substance; cause is a concept, but the concept is not cause.

Power's antilogical discharge, the transition of possibility into actuality, takes place with necessity; but this necessity is, by means of the antilogical itself, a contingency. A line, for example, is to be drawn. The line's concept is possibility of countless lines; but the line that is drawn is expressly this determinate one. Let one draw whatever line one will, it becomes each time a *This*. This is accordingly necessary; but since it could just as well have been any other whatever, precisely *This* is contingent. So with every existing case.

If reflection is made on a series of cases, of which each preceding one makes its successor necessary, we get the contingent necessity more closely determined as *conditioned* necessity. But this logical concept still decides nothing concerning the actual cases. The general series does not exist; each existing series is a *this* series, each member in this series is a *this* member; but this existing member, though grounded in the whole connection, is an antilogical discharge of power.

If reflection is made, finally, on a totality of cases closed in itself, the totality's logical concept is possibility of countless actual totalities, different in their actuality. Each actual totality is *this*, just *this* totality. The members' necessary connection, their mutual dependence and reciprocal conditionedness, cannot be derived from the logical concepts: connection, dependence, conditionedness. The connection is in each totality *this* connection with *this* dependence, *this* conditionedness; grounded in the power-concept: totality, the actual totality is, in other words, an antilogical discharge of power.

Without the knowledge-concepts the power-concepts are impossible; without the power-concepts the things are impossible, and conversely. The infinite reciprocal determination of the logical and the antilogical in the all-capable essence makes it then evident from all sides that the relation between the concepts' logical reflection in pure knowledge, their logical-antilogical reflection in the knowing power, and the antilogical discharges in power's immediacy is a fundamental relation originally corresponding to the opposition of concept and existence, of possibility and actuality.

How existence's particular relations are formed and determined in virtue of this fundamental relation, original in the essence of power, is now to be developed, first from the standpoint of the relative, then from that of the absolute.

b) Relative Power.

Just as self-knowledge and knowledge of the other reciprocally condition each other in pure ideality, so now, from the standpoint of reality, the same must hold of self-power and power in the other.

The ideal and the real do not fall outside each other and cannot be compounded in an outward manner. Knowledge is an ideal power, an essential capability: to know something is, in the intellectual sense, to have power over something (knowledge is power). Conversely, power in its immediacy is an antilogical expression of real knowledge.

At the stage of finitude the ideal power in the form of selfhood is a relative self-power; the object-power, the real power, is power in the other.

α) Relative Self-Power.

Since all knowledge rests on ideal capability, relative self-knowledge is a finitely conditioned self-capability, a relative self-power. (To swoon is to fall into powerlessness.)

That the relative self-power must be conditioned by a relative power over the other, just as self-knowledge by a corresponding knowledge of the other, follows then directly from the unity of knowledge with the ideal power.

Power is the essence of independence, reflected in sublated resistance.

The resistance which knowledge's a priori representations — such ideal members as logic's categories, mathematics' magnitudes, numbers, points, lines, surfaces, bodies, etc. — offer to consciousness affords in its immediacy so fleeting a resistance that our knowing subjectivity can unconditionally be said to have them in its power, so far as it can arbitrarily let them arise, alternate, and vanish. Only when reflection is made on the represented members' mutual relations in such wise that a system of presuppositions, conditions, and consequences forms itself, does an ideal opposition enter between the subjective power in consciousness's reflection and the objective power in the members' connection. A problem is set up, and the problem offers resistance: the thinking consciousness that wrestles with the problem must prove its ideal power by the sublation of the resistance, i.e. by the solution of the problem.

In relation to the abstractly intellectual objects there is only a relative limit for consciousness's power, so far as there is only a relative limit for finite knowledge; but as the human subjectivity steps up, knowing, against existence's actual objects, it must recognize its limited power, its barrier.

The barrier shows itself in the antilogical immediacy with which the sensible object presents itself to the sensing subjectivity. The real is outside, the ideal inside consciousness: the relation between inside and outside is a repelling relation. And yet the object outside is present in its image inside: the influence that goes out from the sensible-thinkable object becomes a moment for that self-activity under which the sensing-thinking I sets it forth before itself and, by this setting-forth of its other, asserts itself. In order to see the object, the seer must be affected by the light going out from the object; but this affecting is only a condition that is absorbed in the self-activity under which the image is formed. The sight-image is object-image; thus the unity immediate in the mirroring is power-unity. And yet the seer's gaze fastens not on the image but on the object; the unity breaks out into opposition, and the object stands in immediate independence before the seer.

The relative self-power is thus recognizable by the original activity with which the knowing (intuiting, representing, thinking) self is capable, under resistance of the other, of winning in what is its own, yet in such wise that in this its own it recognizes its dependence on the other. In the form of knowledge, however, the self-power is

hidden, so far as the determination of the other everywhere has the self-determination beneath it. But as knowledge passes over into willing, the relative self-power becomes completely manifest.

The will's unity with the organs subordinated to it (nerves, muscles, hand-movements, etc.) is a power-unity; for the organic other is a moment for the determining will. Against the will's organic-actual independence the objects of the surrounding world form an opposition in power, whose actual unity in turn results from the self-power. The will expressed in the self-power is in itself determined by representations and concepts; it is in consequence capable of translating new forms, new concepts, into the stuff of otherness (manufactures; art-productions), and in this way reflects its independence in sublated resistance.

The fundamental difference between knowledge's theoretical and the will's practical self-power is typically determined by the relation between the logical and the antilogical. In theory the movement goes from the antilogical over into the logical (from actuality to concept); in practice, conversely, the movement goes from the logical over into the antilogical (from concept to actuality).

β) Power in the Other.

Since otherness is relativity, it follows of itself that power in the other must be relative power. Power's distinguishing mark in this domain is to be sought not merely in the essential difference between concept and thing, but also in the peculiar relation between the things themselves.

Matter and *force* are in the logical sense concepts; but in antilogical immediacy they are actual facts. Existing matter is selfhood's uttermost opposite, power's original discharge in the other. The elementary parts (atoms) constitute an infinite swarm of antilogical real-points, each with relative independence over against the others. The atomistic members are so outwardly separated that on superficial view it looks as though there were no connection between them. This sundering of independent members is characteristic of power; but to posit the independent members as moments in active relations is, after what we have seen, also characteristic of power: the relation between the mutually attracting and repelling atoms is a thoroughgoing otherness-

relation, a power-relation.

Relation is grounded in reflection; every relation, also the relation between the atoms, is reflected; but in the power-relation this reflecting is expressly to be determined as immediate activity.

Regarded for itself, the finite activity is a conditioned manifestation of force: the reflection actualized in the power-relation is force, a logical-antilogical category for reflected fact. Matter for itself is power's immediate expression, force for itself its reflected expression. The difference-unity of matter and force is power-unity, and the power-unity in turn grounds matter's and force's relative opposition (the force in one matter acts on another matter; matter's selflessness: inertia and force).

Things and laws. The relation between the immediate and the reflected power assumes different forms according as the reflection of the logical in the antilogical turns. As unity of atoms and forces the thing, the concrete-material singularity, is a power-unity. But what the thing is in itself, it is only by what it is in its relation to other things (that the knife is sharp means that there is something it can cut); the unity breaks out into opposition: opposition of thing and thing is an antilogical reflection-opposition, an opposition of power and power, reflected in forces and properties.

Through the particular in the reciprocity of forces the power-unity comes into view, not in immediate and concrete form, like the thing, but in the abstract form of affirmative reflection, as the universal power determining the relations of things — as the law.

That the law is power is seen not directly from its being the universal — for the universal in logical abstraction is as yet no law, and the universal in logical concretion (concept, Idea) is not either — but from this, that the universal in the form of universality has power over the singular, has the special cases as immediate facts against it and yet as moments beneath it.

The connection of conditions has for its basis the thoroughgoing power-unity, reflected in the manifold of things, resting on itself in its generality. When the one member is posited, the other must follow, for antecedent and consequent have their subsistence in one and the same universal positing of power. This universal positing of power is the thoroughgoing essentiality of the actual. Outside this essentiality the

things are nothing; they are essenceless; their essence is the universal power, and the power is *over* them. But in and through the essentiality they are independent; their independence is the particular power, and the power is in them. So many systems of specially necessary member-connections, so many forms of the determining universal, so many actual laws.

Wholes and parts. The thing's unity is no self-unity, but on the contrary a unity of other with other. What the thing is in itself, it is in its properties, and what it is in its properties, it is in its law-determined connection with other things: its subsistence in unity is a subsistence in plurality. The thing-unity subsisting in a plurality of things is a wholeness, and the things subordinated to its subsistence are parts. In the form of the concept the relation between whole and parts is a logical reflection-relation: when the whole is essence, the parts are phenomena (mechanical whole), and conversely (chemical whole). But in actuality the relation is a power-relation. The whole's independence rests on the parts' dependence, and the parts' independence rests in turn on a dependence in the whole. Separated from its whole, the part is itself a whole: the whole's independence thus rests on its dependence.

When the parts are apprehended logically as moments reflected in the whole's unity, the existing unity — *this* whole — must be apprehended antilogically; conversely, when the parts — *these* existent parts — are apprehended antilogically, the wholeness must be apprehended logically as the parts' connection-unity.

The unceasing converting of logical and antilogical determinations which on the whole characterizes power in the other, and thereby all outer, immediate actuality, has its ground in this, that the thing, the concept's antilogical expression, is not a concept, and the concept, the thing's logical expression, not a thing.

γ) The Dissolution of the Relative Power.

The relative power has a limit over which it has no power; it has, namely, the limit outside itself in another power. However much it extends itself in the finite, it still cannot get the limit lifted. Since now power's limit is its insuperable resistance, the antilogical expression of its actual restriction, it is evident from this that this restriction must at the same time be the logical proof of its essential powerlessness: all relative

power is powerlessness.

In the form of reflection as well as in that of immediacy, power is reality's expression. Immediately, the power in matter is matter's reality, in the thing the thing's reality, just as the power reflected in force is force's reality, etc. In logical reflection the difference between the immediate and the reflected is a fluid determination that sublates itself: the immediate is reflected, and the reflected in turn immediate; but the antilogical in power fixes the difference fast and transforms the essential transitions into abrupt conversions.

The independent gives way everywhere and yields place to the dependent. On what, indeed, does matter's independence rest? On force. And force's reality? On matter. The reality is in an other, and the reality of the other in turn in an other; the mass has no reality in itself, its reality is in the atoms; but the atoms have no reality in themselves either, for their reality is in the mass. To ascribe reality to the atoms by declaring them independent parts is of no avail, for the independent part is not a part but a whole. That the object as a whole consists of parts is to say, in other words, that it is in the parts' power; but the parts are in turn, by means of the connection, in the whole's power: the whole is powerless on account of the parts, and the parts powerless on account of the whole.

That the relative self-power is likewise powerlessness is easy to see; it has in the other its outward limit, and in the limit its reality. Knowledge's limit is its powerlessness; finite knowledge cannot clarify things through and through, for the knower does not have the actual things in his power. The will's limit is its powerlessness; for the finite will, however strong it be, and the strength of selfhood, however great it be, has in the outward things a resistance it cannot overcome: its resistance is its relativity, and the relativity its powerlessness. (Thor in Jotunheim). The self's organically conditioned independence is its dependence; its reality rests on the organs, but the organs' reality is otherness-reality, and this otherness-reality is the self's powerlessness (old age, sickness, death).

c) The Absolute Power.

That the relative discharges of power, the finite realities, dissolve into powerlessness at their logical-antilogical limits by no means signifies that power vanishes, that the actual world becomes an empty semblance; but it signifies that all finite independence must be recognized as otherness-expression of the infinite power. In and through the infinite power everything finite has subsistence; as the power-unity which, in the things' relative independence, has power over its original opposite and thereby over itself, the infinite power is absolute.

α) Absolute Self-Power.

The infinite power is not to be apprehended as the infinite substance (Spinoza). By apprehending the infinite power as substance one makes the essence subsisting in itself into an immediate being. But if the infinite substance is to be the sole being, its opposite (the finite things, the accidents) must necessarily be determined as non-being; or in the language of reflection: if the infinite substance is to be the sole independent essence, the existing things in their finitude must be essenceless, consequently without any independence. And yet this is not to be understood as though the finite things were without being and essence; on the contrary! that which is in them is the substance itself with its attributes: thinking and extension. Just as the thinking beings (souls) are modifications of the attribute of thinking, special limitations of the one thinking being, so the extended beings (bodies) are limitations in the substance's infinite extension.

But wherein does the essential reality consist — where now is the power? The infinite substance is powerless; for the unity is without opposition. The substance is in actuality not its own cause (*causa sui*); the cause demands a substantial opposition of cause and effect, but such a self-separation is excluded by the substance-unity's immediate being. Over against the finite things the infinite substance is only an empty shadow; its substantiality is in the things; the things' limitation is its own limitation, its own finitude: instead of being in independent unity it exists only in infinite plurality. But the plurality is, according to the limitation (*omnis determinatio est negatio*), dependence: far from being the substance present in all finite things, the

substance-unity has on the contrary become substanceless: the finite negations have sucked the blood of its essence and deprived it of all substantiality. It is not in itself, for it is immediately in its other, and it is not in its other, for it is immediately in itself; it is neither in itself nor in its other: it is a contradiction.

The substantial contradiction is solved as the actual doubling, the power-doubling itself, comes into view. The infinite power-unity consists in actual self-opposition; it is not an existent substance, but a substantial activity, a self-activity that has its other in itself by having it against itself: in this self-activity the original self has infinite substantiality, and in this substantiality consists its absolute self-power.

If the absolute self-power now annihilated the things' independence, it would at the same time annihilate itself; it would then become a power over shadows, a shadow-power. But if the finite substances could subsist by themselves in outward opposition to the self-power, then the self-power would itself be relative and, in its relativity, powerless. Only in that the self-power, through its own opposition, is power in the other do the existing things have relative substantiality; their independence among themselves is grounded in their dependence on the self-power: through the power in the other the absolute self-power is overreaching sole power.

β) Sole Power and Superior Power.

Dependence and superior power are relative concepts; but it makes an essential difference whether the relative is determined in relation to another relative, or is taken up and affirmed in the absolute. Let A, B, and C be three relative members, each with its independence. A can now gain superior power by making B and C dependent; but this superior power, however great it be, can never become sole power. Sole power in A would presuppose that B and C had to such a degree lost all independence that they could offer no resistance at all. But when all resistance vanishes, the superior power vanishes too; when the vanquished is crushed, the mighty one stands alone (the thrall is dependent on the master, for as existing individual he is independent outside the master; but the dead man is not dependent on the living: the dependence vanished with the independence). Thus: when the sole power is posited, the superior power is sublated; when the superior power is posited, the sole power is sublated.

Otherwise, when the relative is taken up into the absolute.

If the relative were not, neither were the absolute; if the absolute had the relative outside itself, it were itself relative; the relative has independence as moment in the absolute: as the absolute is determined, its moments, the relative members, must then also be determined. In logical reflection the absolute is the concept completed in its comprehending self, and its relative determinations concept-determinations, relative concepts; but in the form of power, with the antilogical elements, the absolute is infinite substantiality, and its real moments are relative substances.

With the relative substances' absolute dependence on the absolute self-unity, the sole power is united with the superior power. The superior power is sole power, for the relative substances are only otherness-determinations of the self-power determining itself in everything; the sole power is superior power, for the substantial otherness-determinations are, as power's antilogical discharges, relative substances: absolute sole power is absolute superior power.

If in this relation one-sided weight is laid on the sole power, the absolute self-power becomes the only efficient cause (*causa efficiens*), and the relative substances — the intellectual as well as the material — become the cause's substantial effects. These effects have indeed, in finite separation, a certain independence, so far as they are substantial; but their dependence shows itself in this, that as effects they are not themselves causes. The one efficient cause (the almighty will) must itself everywhere produce the reciprocity between the effected members. Instead of being efficient causes, the relative substances are thus reduced to being passage-members for the all-effecting cause and thereby to being mere occasional causes (*causæ occasionales*; Malebranche).

By this conception the substances have again become substanceless; they are again shadows: the dependence has vanished with the independence, and the efficient sole power has sunk down into a meaningless shadow-power.

For the sake of the dependence, weight must accordingly be laid on the superior power. On the resistance-power presupposed in the essence of the superior power rests the relative substances' actuality: their actuality is that they act upon one another mutually. Actuality consists in active relations. That two masses exhibit attraction

does not mean that the absolutely willing self-power takes occasion from the existing members to bring them nearer each other; it is not the attraction, but its concept, in which the self-power expresses its superior power. It lies in the concept of space-filling, place-taking matter that the determination of the place one mass occupies must be reflected in the determination of the place occupied by another mass; thus the attraction is determined by the concept. But the concept does not act as concept; the concept of attraction is not attracting; the thing is cause, but the cause is not thing. It is the masses which, in virtue of the cause-concept, attract each other reciprocally; but the cause-concept does not attach to the thing as if the thing could be thing without being cause; the existing thing is the concept stepping out into power, converted into existence: the existing thing is efficient cause.

The things are absolutely dependent on the concepts; in this dependence they have their independence; but the concepts are, according to their origin, absolutely dependent on the comprehender: the comprehending sole power thus has, in virtue of the concepts, infinite superior power over the thing.

γ) The Idea of Power.

The concept is the thing's ideal, and the thing the concept's real, power. The unity of the ideal and the real power is the Idea of Power.

Apprehended for itself in logical generality, the power-concept is a reflection-category, a peculiar knowledge-form, a one-sided concept among several others. But, seen in the Idea, power's infinity receives its light from knowledge. Every power-concept is a knowledge-concept, but not conversely. The knowledge-concept for itself is powerless; it reflects the thing in the thing's semblance; its reflecting is only a shining, a mirroring. The power-concept, on the other hand, whose reflecting of antilogical moments is positively posited as activity, is actuality-capacity, capacity for actuality, the actual's real possibility. The sharply marked opposition of concept and thing, of possibility and actuality, is, as we have seen, an opposition within power in power itself, an opposition of negatively reflected and positively immediate power.

The real-concept then shows itself, from the Idea's standpoint, in a double-sided relation to the thing; it is indwelling in the thing and yet infinitely overreaching.

The concept of sulphur, for example, is indwelling in sulphur; its existence is the sulphur existing in a given state. And yet sulphur in antilogical-immediate existence is infinitely far from expressing the whole concept. To exhaust the content of its concept, sulphur must pass through all possible states, show itself in all possible combinations; but actuality permits each time only *this* state, *this* determinate combination: actuality, the antilogical determinateness, is finite; but possibility, the logical essentiality, is infinite. Sulphur's concept is not merely reflected in a peculiar circle of kindred stuff-concepts; it is, through the stuff-concepts' reflection, originally reflected in the whole infinite system of concept-systems: as Idea-form the finite concept is infinite.

The fundamental relation between the indwelling and the overreaching real-concept unfolds itself in an opposition of two heterogeneous circles of movement, the ideal and the real, whose unity in the Idea is a thoroughgoing inference-unity.

In the ideal circle the movement goes through real-negations of antilogical reflexes from concept to concept, without the ideal activity at any point coming to discharge in outer actuality. Such stuff-concepts as oxygen, hydrogen, carbon, gold, etc., can be comprehended only by being reflected in a system of logical universal concepts. What such a reflection has to signify can be seen from the immanent logic's dialectical analyses. The stuff-concepts named are special modifications of the substance-concept. The special arises by regard to the stuffs themselves, hence by reflexes of the antilogical; but the emphasis falls not on the existing substances' peculiarity, but on their universal essentiality, i.e. on *the concept: substance*. The substance-concept is the logically developed essence-concept, the essence-concept the logically developed being-concept. The movement goes synthetically: from being through essence to substance; analytically: from substance through essence to being.

That the development of the categories which the immanent logic is able to give is by no means the absolute knowledge's own unfolding, but only a formal-dialectical dissolution of the finite reflection in the infinite, has already been shown. Nonetheless there is in the development a reflected shine of the eternal logic, a reflected splendour of the divine reason, whose inexhaustible depth is selfhood.

In the real circle the movement takes place from actuality through possibility to actuality, in that the possibility everywhere rests on the indwelling concept's logical

overreaching beyond the finite limit, while actuality indicates the limit antilogically. Actuality of given things is possibility of other things (the actuality of oxygen and hydrogen is the possibility of water); the by-things co-operating with the principal things afford conditions.

Through possibility the things by no means go beyond their own concepts, but they overstep the actuality-limit to which the existent's antilogical determinateness is bound. If there were not more in the thing's concept than there immediately is in the existing thing, the thing could not perish; if there were not more in the actual's concept than in the actual itself, the actuality of the one could not be possibility of the other; but if the one's actuality were not the other's possibility, nothing could be grounded: no thing could arise out of the ground.

The fact that the things' possibilities are hidden under the forms of actuality has occasioned the misunderstanding that possibility did not actually exist (the Megarics' assertion), a misunderstanding that only proves the impossibility of making things into concepts and concepts into things. It is precisely *the secret of the Idea of Power* that in the world of things there are no concepts, because the things themselves, in their being, becoming, and transitions, exhaust the concepts.

The two circles now form two worlds, a world of concepts, *the ideal system*, and a world of things, *the real system*. From the one of these two worlds there is no finite transition to the other: from concepts come concepts, from things things, into the infinite. The transition from concept to existence cannot possibly be thought in such wise that the all-comprehending self should first specially think out for itself a special concept and thereupon apply power in order to produce the object corresponding to the concept. If the matter stood thus, power would be arbitrarily joined on to knowledge, the things' actual connection would be broken, and the real possibility, conditioned by the connection, groundless (the rose, for example, would then by a fiat of power step forth immediately out of the rose's concept, the horse out of the horse's concept, etc.); but a fiat of power that breaks the things' connection sublates all logic.

The fundamental concept that expresses the concept's and actuality's original unity in power is the concept *disposition*.

In the world of things the reciprocal determination of actuality and possibility

runs out into endless series: the actuality of A is the possibility of B; as A goes to the ground, B comes forth out of the ground, steps out into existence and becomes an actuality; but the actuality of B is in turn the possibility of C, and so forth. What now is herein the originally determining? It cannot be the actual, for the actuality in every succeeding member is precisely determined by the possibility lying in the preceding one. Nor can it be the possible, for the possibility in every preceding member is expressly determined by its own actuality. The fundamentally determining must necessarily be sought in a concept which in the form of possibility has taken up all the moments of actuality, and thus in and through the possibility has predetermined actuality. But the predetermination is possible only in that the concept in the form of actuality has predetermined all becoming possibilities. On account of the possibilities' predetermined unity, the concept has power over the actual's manifold. The unity of the possibilities is at bottom itself the actual's own presupposed unity; with actuality's unity as basis the concept has power over the possibilities' manifold: this power-concept, characteristic by its doubling of positing and presupposing, is the disposition.

In the disposition power is concept, and the concept power. To reflect on the concept is to determine the disposition's relation to possibility; to reflect on the power is to determine its relation to actuality.

Disposition and possibility. Every disposition is a possibility, but not every possibility is a disposition. The difference rests on the conditions. In the outward, finite world the relations are outward, and from the outward relations follow *outward* conditions. Now so far as the real possibilities indwelling in the things depend on outer conditions, they are possibilities pure and simple, not dispositions (possibility of a rainbow; possibility of rain and wind, etc.). In the essence of things, in the system of real-concepts, the relations are on the contrary inward; to the inward demands lying in the determinate real-concepts correspond the *inward* conditions: the possibility originally determined by its inward conditions is a disposition (the germ in the seed).

Disposition and actuality. Every disposition is an actuality (the seed; the animal semen); but not conversely. To the possibility with the outward conditions corresponds the outward actual in which there is no disposition (a stone barrow); the actual in which there is disposition is a selfhood-product, is expressly to be determined by

indwelling selfhood (organ, organism). To be sure, the merely outward, selfless actual can be apprehended from the standpoint of selfhood, and its indwelling possibility so far determined as disposition. Thus one can say, for example, with respect to water, that in oxygen there is a disposition to combination with hydrogen, and in hydrogen a disposition to combination with oxygen. But this by no means proves that the selfless outward is in itself a disposition; it shows only that the finitude in the outward actual is posited by the self as passage-member for the overreaching concept, and thereby reduced to a condition for satisfying a demand of selfhood upon the other.

Disposition and end. The absolute concept-demand is a selfhood-demand, a totality-demand closed in itself; the demand expressly presupposes an other in which and whereby it is to be fulfilled: between the demand and the fulfilment lies the disposition.

The disposition is the fulfilment's real possibility, the demand's first, immediate satisfaction. But this immediacy is in itself unsatisfying; for it conflicts with the disposition's essence to remain in the immediate state of disposition. The first, original disposition expresses, namely, not merely the immediate actuality's dependence on the determining totality-concept; it expresses at the same time that the totality, whose actuality is as yet only a possibility, is to be developed to full actuality: the fully developed totality is the demand's last, absolute satisfaction, a satisfaction that can be reached only by the roundabout way of mediacy. Hereby the concept disposition passes over, from the subjective as well as from the objective side, into the concept *end*.

Subjectively the end is posited in the totality-concept corresponding to the selfhood-demand. According to its free, overreaching form this concept, determined by the comprehending selfhood, belongs to the ideal system; but in virtue of the disposition it must, as we have seen, belong just as originally to the real system, for the disposition's possibility presupposes actuality. Through the disposition the transition takes place from the ideal to the real system, hence not in a finite but in an infinite manner: it takes place through the end (first extreme).

In order to determine the whole actual totality, the concept must beforehand be determined as end. In and through the end-concept the real-concepts are prior to the things (*universalia ante rem*); but in virtue of the actual end they are at the same

time indwelling in the things (*universalia in re*). The totality's development out of the disposition is the parts', the particular members', development: the finite comes forth out of the infinite; thus arise the means (second extreme).

The means in their immediate singularity are antilogical; the end in its universal essentiality is logical. But the end is actual only as the means' end: the logical in the end is thus, in virtue of the means, antilogical. Conversely, the world of things with its possibilities, conditions, and actuality-sides is a world of means; these means are the end's own means: the antilogical in the means is thus, in virtue of the end, logical (the inference's unity is unity in power).

In the real world, the actual totality of end and means, the reciprocal determination of the logical and the antilogical in the essence of power is infinitely articulated: the Idea of Power is the articulated form-determinations' absolute content.

C. Truth.

The essential difference between knowledge and power develops itself through the ideal and the real system into complete opposition; but the Idea is in both systems the unity of its own opposition, and by this unity is everywhere to be determined as truth.

Everything, even the untrue, has its truth (a true lie); and yet it is precisely truth itself that makes untruth manifest (*verum est index sui et falsi*).

In the form of reflection, truth is unity of thinking and being: thinking has its truth in being, and being in thinking; untruth is accordingly discord between thinking and being. In the form of judgment, truth is identity of subject and predicate: the object (the subject) has its truth in the concept (the fully developed predicate), and conversely; untruth, the contradiction in the judgment, is accordingly strife between subject and predicate. In the form of inference, truth is the middle of the extremes: the more independent the extremes, the fuller the middle, and the deeper the truth; untruth, on the other hand, is the middle's dissolution into the mutually devouring extremes (spiritualism — materialism).

The logical development of the Idea of Truth's peculiar fundamental forms has in selfhood the principle of subjective truth, in otherness the principle of objective truth, and in the self-unity infinitely returning through its otherness-totality the principle of absolute truth.

The threefold truth-principle has, in the subjective as well as in the objective extreme, laws of development for the whole truth (dualism); but the one-sidedness with which each of the extremes is burdened must be lifted in the original middle in which they come to agreement. The extremes are not equalized by being dissolved, so that the middle becomes merely the neutral; their equalization is that the opposition is

preserved in the unity (identity-dualism). The inference-unity in which the opposition subsists is then itself the absolute beginning-unity from which it proceeds.

a) Subjective Truth.

The principle is selfhood; hence the logical emphasis falls on the independence which subjectivity is in a position to found on otherness's overcome resistance, in that, in overcoming the resistance, it grounds itself. The self-grounding shows itself at different depths as we, beginning with the finite subjectivity, work our way forward, through a dialectical dissolution of finitude's barriers, to the concept of the absolute subjectivity.

α) Finite Subjectivity.

The judging self is the measure of things; by this proposition an essential mark of subjective truth is indicated. But the proposition becomes untrue when the judgment is to concern the essence of things and rest on the immediate subject's contingent mood (Protagoras). The proposition's truth depends on subjectivity's truth; subjectivity's truth depends on its judgment about itself; but its judgment about itself depends in turn on the force of inwardness with which, in original self-positing, it has been able to ground the independence of its essence.

Subjectivity is no immediately given object, no object subsisting for itself; the object arising through self-objectivation is the subject itself: the truth in the object rests on the truth in the subject, hence on the selfhood-energy with which the objectivation goes on. That the selfhood-energy is the truth means that subjectivity itself makes itself into the truth — that, in other words, truth is unconditionally subjective.

The finite subjectivity's contradiction now shows itself in this, that as subjectivity it is to posit the whole subjective truth in itself, and yet as finite subjectivity, restricted by finite objects and objective conditions, it must have the truth in an other than itself: its activity and striving must accordingly aim at solving this contradiction.

Subjectivity's finitude is seen in its strife with the barriers. The finitude rests not merely on the self's restriction by the outer objective; also in its inner, in the relation

between its thinking and willing, the finitude is seen. There is a willing in all thinking, and a thinking in all willing; but the opposition of thought and will steps forth in all its finitude when subjectivity is to posit the truth in its own essence; for subjectivity's truth, the most subjective element in subjectivity's self-positing, is its will.

In order that the truth may be posited in the will, the will must lay thinking under requisition: the categories run on deliberation and choice. In deliberation, thinking labours not to see into the validity of things in themselves, but only to find out the possibilities decisive for the will. When from the circumstances at hand it has found out two or more possible cases, the will is to choose. How deep-going the difference between subjective and objective thinking is will in this connection easily be seen.

Faced with an objective theorem, thinking can indeed begin subjectively, so far as it can begin by deliberating how the proof may best be conducted; but that the conduct of the proof is itself objective is seen from this, that the proof ends by making choice impossible. The proven theorem must be accepted as it is; here there is no choice at all: the necessity is objective. It is the converse with deliberation; it does not end with an irrefutable proof that one of the several cases possible for the will is the only necessary one. On the contrary! The more decisive the question of will is, the plainer it becomes that for each of the alternatives set up there are grounds both against and for. The grounds for can be outweighed into the infinite by the grounds against, and conversely. To end the deliberation, endless in reflection, the will must choose. The choice is necessary, and when the crisis is great, unconditionally necessary; but the necessity is subjective.

Whether now the will under the given circumstances has made a true or an untrue choice cannot be decided objectively by regard to the final outcome, for the outcome is, in the moment of deliberation, only a possibility, not an actuality. What the outcome can at length clear up is, in the objective sense, solely whether the choice has been fortunate or unfortunate, beneficial or harmful for the matter concerned; but these finitude-determinations still decide nothing about the truth in the choosing subjectivity. *To choose is to venture*: the truth rests on the depth of self-understanding in which the chooser has recognized his *responsibility*.

To take responsibility upon oneself is to posit the truth in the self; the strength

of inwardness with which this happens receives its expression in the resolution with which the choice is held fast.

Subjective truth is related to objective truth as resolution to inference. The conclusion (*conclusum*) drawn from an inference's presuppositions (premises) may not contain more than what is incontestably grounded in the presuppositions: this is the conclusion's objective necessity; in this necessity it has its truth. Of the resolution the opposite holds. As the resolution is taken, the will's self-positing adds something of its own, something not to be found in the deliberation's premises, and this something, the closing itself, is precisely the decisive element.

In the objective inference it is the premises that must vouch for the conclusion's validity; therefore the rational act is ended with the inference itself. In the resolution, the subjective inference, the will's self-positing is on the contrary a positing of the consequent which, under the weight of responsibility, must vouch for the premises' validity. The resolution, which is borne only by grounds it must itself bear, is at its maximum an antirational act. The antirational in the resolution's inner actuality corresponds exactly to the antilogical in the thing's outer actuality: in the friction between the inner and the outer actuality the resolution steps out, to be objectivated in actual action.

How the finite subjectivity, in the endeavour to posit the truth in itself, must step by step struggle with contradictions is then obvious. To make a choice, it must lean on deliberation; but deliberation's contradiction is that its grounds for and against are not grounding. Only the choice is capable of making a ground insufficient in itself sufficient as motive: a motive is a subjective ground, a ground the will has adopted on its own responsibility. The contradiction that the will both has and yet does not have a truly grounding ground the resolution must strike down as action is proceeded to. But the contradiction returns with redoubled force. The subject in its finitude, namely, does not take the resolution unconditionally for its own sake, but also for the action's sake. The action's outcome is only in part dependent on the agent, and yet the agent has taken the responsibility upon himself. The outward-going action, which was to prove the truth of the choice and therewith of the resolution, can then precisely by its outcome turn against the acting subject and convince it that the truth represented in

choice and resolution was after all an untruth.

β) Subjectivity's Abstract Infinity.

The subject's finitude is its untruth; if this proposition is held fast by itself, the task must become to infinitize subjectivity. As existing individual the subject is subjected to finitude's terms; it lacks the power to subject the outer concrete actuality unconditionally to itself. The infinitizing must accordingly begin with the self, by a peculiar practical abstraction, freeing itself from the outward and contingent and declaring everything that does not stand in its power indifferent; the truth then lies not in things and events, but in the self's universal essence, in the thinking-willing subject's agreement with itself.

The existing subject has thus placed itself at the standpoint of infinity; deliberation is transformed into essential self-recollection, and choice into unconditional self-choice.

In the self-recollection subjectivity then does not begin by clearing up its position toward these or those actuality-tasks, finding out these or those alternatives — all such concerns only finitude, and finitude is untruth — no, it will in the infinity of its thinking itself be the truth; so the subject raises itself above its individual limitation, converts its natural singularity into a thought singularity, and leans on the logical judgment: *I, the singular, am the universal*.

To the infinity of thinking corresponds the infinity of the will. That an outward-going will wills in the world of things this or that singular is of subordinate significance. Just as the will in its natural singularity is untrue, so also everything outwardly singular at which the will aims is something in itself indifferent and untrue. *The true singular will is the universal will*; the universal will's object is not the outward but the inward singular, is the universal, willing self, for only in the self as thinking is the singular itself the universal.

In its universal, liberated self-being, subjectivity is now to set about sublating the action's finitude and transforming the resolution into an adequate inference. And this can indeed very well be done — namely, by the help of abstraction.

Thinking, which at this stage is no longer practically finite but theoretically infinite,

is a thinking of the thinking essence's universal validity; the content of selfhood is clarified in the light of truth: subjectivity becomes transparent to itself. The transparency is conditioned by the thought-essence originally positing its universal being in the form of thinking; this is the self-energy's first extreme.

The will, which at abstraction's high point has ceased to be a finite, arbitrarily choosing singular will, is, though one with thinking, yet different from thinking. Thinking strives from the singular toward the universal, the will conversely from the universal toward the singular: it is the same striving, and yet a different striving. On account of the difference between thinking and will, the content of selfhood must then pass over from the form of thinking into the will, must by a peculiar self-energy be determined as the will's content; thus the second extreme forms itself.

The middle of the extremes is the ground itself from which they proceed; it is the thinking-willing subjectivity's original self-unity; in this unity's self-development they have their truth. The ground-division corresponding to the judgment-act yields two judgments: *the self's universal content is a thought-content*, and *the self's universal content is a will-content*; but the two judgments are premises for one inference: the inference-act is the self-activity gathered in its universal, the pure logical act, freed from finitude. In the closing-together of the extremes the resolution is then transformed into an inference necessary in itself, logically adequate. The necessary form-doubling whereby the extremes arise is grounded in the essence-unity in which they go together as into their original middle. There lies then nothing at all in the concluding proposition beyond what is contained in the premises; at the transition from the form of thinking to the form of will, the will has nothing to add: it has no choice, no risk, no responsibility, for the transition takes place with necessity. The will wills what it *must* will: freedom is necessity; but what the will must will, it wills of itself from its essence's inner prompting: necessity is freedom (*libera necessitas*).

But just as subjectivity, in this transparent self-being of its essence, has gathered itself out of the dim manifold of life's distractions and thrust the finite from itself, it gets in earnest to do with finitude.

The transparent self-being is an infinitely empty being; every moment of difference, every condition of concretion, every least gleam of content it owes to reflexes of other-

being. The whole liberation, founded on necessity, is conditioned by an energetic abstraction; but the abstraction's energy is precisely conditioned by the finitude from which abstraction is made. If subjectivity will hold the abstraction fast in order to keep finitude out, it becomes itself a hollow abstractum, a metaphysical shadow-essence. If for concretion's sake it will engage with finitude, then the cleft between the nature-bound singular, the existing individual, and the singular of thought, the selfhood transparent to itself, becomes so wide that the whole of finitude streams in, fills and overwhelms the abstract-universal subjectivity.

The individual's universal will cannot possibly come to existence except through its determinate singular will. The object of this singular will is not the universal itself, but a singularity existing in the world of things, in which the universal is to be expressed. (No one can in all generality do the general duty; but the singular person can and ought in each single case to do his duty). So practical thinking parts again from theoretical; so deliberation, choice, resolution, with all the contradictions pointed out in them, begin over again, and subjectivity is no longer transparent to itself.

The universal willing of the universal is unactual, and the same holds of the pure, universal acting. The actual action is, even when it belongs to inwardness, invariably an action in the particular by means of the given singular, hence a particular action. The truth in the particular action now depends on: 1) that the action in its singularity is the will's complete expression; 2) that in its connection with other particular actions, through which the acting subjectivity, in solving a determinate actuality-task, will unconditionally satisfy itself, it corresponds exactly to the aim. If these two conditions are to be fulfilled, subjectivity must have the particular action, its actual execution, its outcome and consequences, in its power; here no abstracting helps, no creeping into shelter behind the universal: subjectivity has the responsibility.

To declare the finitude-elements that do not stand in the individual's power contingent, unessential, and indifferent is an empty evasion. If subjectivity cannot get its actual will actually carried through: then the concrete actuality has broken through the singular will's universal, and truth demands a confession that the alleged self-agreement is an actual self-contradiction. If subjectivity will extricate itself from the entanglements by letting the actual tasks drop and beginning over with a willing of

the universal in the universal, it falls back into the abstraction, and truth requires a confession that the alleged self-agreement is an essential contradiction.

If the universal in all actual actions, the pure, universal acting, is to be the only essential, then the actual actions in their singularity become unessential; and the truth, or rather the untruth, is that the universal action itself becomes unactual on account of the abstraction. If conversely the actual actions, the universal action's actual expression, are made the essential on account of the concretion: then the finite gets power over the infinite; the circumstances in the singular overwhelm the will in the universal, and the untrue subjectivity, entangled in self-contradictions, collapses in powerlessness.

γ) The Absolute Subjectivity.

Subjectivity's untruth has shown itself from two principal sides: first, in its finitude it will posit itself as the truth — that is a glaring contradiction; next, when the self-contradiction has become manifest, it will by a radical abstraction, despite its finitude, make itself one with the infinite: the latter is in the logical sense worse than the former. The consequence is that the immanent logic reduces the subjective to a moment sublated in the Idea and deifies objectivity. The Idea is indeed to be the unity of the subjective and the objective; but the universal is the objective: the overreaching universal must then make truth itself absolutely objective.

The fundamental contradiction is obvious. If the original subjectivity is not itself absolute, there is no absolutely knowing self; if there is no absolutely knowing self, there is no absolute knowledge; if there is no absolute knowledge, there is no absolute truth. Therefore: in the name of truth the eternal, unoriginated subjectivity must be absolute.

Hereby objectivity is neither excluded nor weakened; objectivity is in the power; the absolute subjectivity is knowledge's and power's original self-unity: the absolute subjectivity is the truth. But self-unity of knowledge and power is will-unity; the task becomes accordingly: to determine the concept of the absolute will.

How does the relative proceed from the absolute? With absolute necessity! This answer is *correct* so long as the fundamental relation is apprehended in all generality,

for as the relative's possibility the absolute is itself impossible without the relative. But when the question *in concreto* is about this or that antilogically determined relative, the relation becomes quite another. In its proceeding from the absolute, namely, the relative is itself a relative absolute, a totality in a peculiar disposition. From the disposition-concept in general to the disposition determined in actuality there is a leap that no necessity-concept can fill.

If the absolute in itself were nothing other than the dim ground overfilled with existence-content, then the absolute necessity with which the existent broke forth out of the ground would be one with blind contingency. But to begin with blind contingency is to begin as illogically as possible. Therefore: how does the general totality-concept pass over into becoming this, just this power-concept, corresponding to this, just this totality — in other words: how does the disposition, determinable in all indeterminacy, pass over into being determined? To this decisive question logic has only one decisive answer: it happens in virtue of an absolute choice.

The finite subjectivity has only a choice between two or more possibilities restricted by finitude's conditions; deliberation must go before, to find out what under the given circumstances may be regarded as the best: the choice between a relatively better and worse is a relative choice. The absolute subjectivity, on the other hand, has, as regards the disposition, not merely two or three but countless possibilities; for otherness, the infinite stuff of actuality, receives all its determinateness from the determining real-concept; but the real-concept itself must originally be determined by the all-comprehending self-determining: for the unconditioned self-determining, the absolute will, everything is possible.

Subjectivity's absolute superiority over the disposition-task shows itself just in this, that the task can be solved in countless ways; the one of the alternating possibilities is, for the infinite comprehending, not better or worse, not dimmer or clearer than the other: they are in the depth of grounds equally grounded, equally clear, equally possible. But if all the disjunctive judgment's alternating possibilities are equally possible, then, did the choice not enter, they would all be equally impossible: in order not to drown in a sea of possibilities, the absolute subjectivity must absolutely choose this or that determinate possibility and express the disposition-concept in this or that

determinate disposition.

The choice is necessary in the absolute in so far as it is absolutely necessary that a choice be made; but what is chosen — which of the possible cases, the possibilities equally grounded in the concept, is chosen — rests on the will alone. When the absolute subjectivity then chooses this, just this possibility, this, just this disposition, the will satisfies itself unconditionally. This is the rational-antirational that makes the self-determination into will; it is the divine, absolutely thorough arbitrariness: *sic volo, sic jubeo, stat pro ratione voluntas*.

The absolute choice is one with the absolute resolution. At the stage of finitude it looks like a defect in the resolution that it cannot be built on objective assurance, cannot coincide with an inference grounded in itself. From the absolute standpoint the relation is reversed. It is precisely a perfection in the resolution that it takes the inference up into its ground and stands above the inference. The inference belongs to the concept as concept, and for that reason can never reach beyond the universal essentiality of the concept-systems. That the unity of disposition and execution, of end and means, is in actuality an inference-unity is to say, in other words, that it is a logical-antilogical concept-unity.

But the antilogical in the outer actuality corresponds, as already shown, to the antirational in subjectivity's inner actuality, to the will's choice — hence to that which completes the inference in resolution.

If the resolution could be torn loose from the inference, then the absolute subjectivity could at the same time tear itself loose from the absolute reason, and the antirational, the counter-rational, would be what conflicts with reason. But the resolution expresses just the converse; it expresses, namely, that subjectivity precisely satisfies reason's demand in that, by applying the factor of self-determination, it integrates the universal reason-grounds and transforms them into will-grounds⁵.

The absolute resolution is one with the absolute action; by means of the absolute action, having power over the conditions, the will in the absolute is the original cause of everything relative.

This cause of causes is in the action itself at once both ideal and real. It is *ideal*; its

⁵How the opposition between two absolutely heterogeneous principles of cognition proceeds from this, cf. the author's Religionsphilosophie Side 28–35; 76–81, and several other places.

ideality is its merging in the system of grounds, its agreement with the eternal reason in the absolute knowledge. It is *real*; its reality is the self-power's unity with the power in the other. The will in the absolute action is the all-articulating actuality-principle, the principle that in the world of things makes the ground into cause and the cause into ground; thus the will is the all-capable objectivity-principle.

The absolute action is the complete expression of the will's activity in the realm of power. It utters itself in the relative, in everything finite; but it does not begin finitely here or there. In virtue of its unconditionally subjective essence, it aims decisively at the objective. It is the universal acting, for it aims at the universal: it is in the end the overreaching that determines the means, in the real-concepts the energy that determines the things. It is an infinite system of particular actions, for it aims at the particular: it is the genus's energy in the species, the species' in the individuals. It aims at the singular, for it confirms otherness's right, the relative substances' antilogical independence: it makes the things into causes, the parts into means, the individuals into bearers of the species' disposition.

In the absolute subjectivity the truth is absolute, but absolutely subjective.

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